Punjab, who was a confidant of Jinnah.[13] By early October, this force had gained control of almost the entire Poonch district except for the town of Poonch that was still being garrisoned by the Jammu and Kashmir state forces. Flush with his success, Sardar Muhammad Ibrahim Khan proclaimed the formation of a provincial Azad Jammu and Kashmir government in Pallandri, a township in Sudhanoti district, on 24 October 1947.[14]

The same day, the invasion force of *Kabailis*, now led by Col. (later Major General) Akbar Khan of the Pakistan Army who had adopted the invasion *nom de plume* of Gen. Tariq, had taken over Muzaffarabad and Uri. The *Kabailis* had destroyed the electricity sub-station at Mahura, which supplied power to Srinagar. The city was plunged into an eerie cloak of darkness. Of their own volition, the raiders got sidetracked in an orgy of rape, plunder and loot at Baramulla. Though the road to Srinagar was open and lay undefended, the short-sighted *Kabailis* ignored the orders of their commanders took to behaving like barbarians. Only when the town had been stripped of its money, firearms, jewellery, women and boys, was their thirst satisfied. It was their stay at the prosperous town of Baramulla for three crucial days that gave the Maharaja the shock that was finally able to shake him off his inertia. Even the arrival of the Pir of Manki Sharif could not detach the *Kabailis* from Baramulla. Only when this loot had been collected, divided and dispatched to the tribal areas in NWFP, would their advance to Srinagar be resumed. There is no doubt that the ranks of the *Kabailis* were buttressed by units from the Frontier Corps and Frontier Constabulary. However, their lack of disciplined leadership was their Achilles' heel. If the original version of Operation Gulmarg had been retained, as was the plan of Operation Datta Khel, the invasion force would have been led by British mercenaries who had resigned from their commissions from the Frontier Corps, Frontier Constabulary and the political department. This entire force would have been in uniforms and headgear a little different from the clothing of the ordinary tribesmen. It is our guess that because of the snafu concerning Maj. Kalkat in Bannu, all British mercenaries were asked to stand down. This is what explains the